

# 19 — Key blocks: rebuilding DOM on demand

## KEY BLOCKS DOM COMPONENTS

### Q. What does the `{#key}` block do in Svelte?

**ANSWER.** The `{#key}` block watches an expression. Whenever that expression changes, Svelte destroys everything inside the block and recreates it from scratch. Components inside are freshly instantiated, their state starts over, and transitions play again.

**WHY IT WORKS.** Svelte uses the key to decide identity. Same key means same content, patched as usual. New key means new content, so the old DOM and component instances are thrown away and rebuilt.

ArticlePage.svelte

```
<script>
  let { article } = $props();
</script>

{#key article.id}
  <ArticleView {article} />
{/key}
```

#### WHAT `{#KEY}` DOES

key = article.id

WHEN THE VALUE CHANGES



block contents

destroyed and recreated · transitions replay

**i Summary.** When the key expression changes, Svelte throws away everything inside the block

and rebuilds it. Use `{#key}` when you need a guaranteed fresh start.